

Date: 6-02-26

Int. Organization; Day.

Introduction:

In a globalized world, where all countries are intensively connected with each other, there are some social and political issues which are affecting the world as a whole.

Therefore, collective effort is required to settle such kinds of problems.

No one state is able to handle global issues on its own.

Therefore, states need a global platform which provide them opportunities to discuss and resolve all the problems.

For Example: After 9/11 terrorism is not a local or regional but a global issue.

Terrorists are operating in different countries simultaneously.

Shortly speaking, global issues require global efforts.

These kinds of global issues forced countries to create an international organization to settle those issues.

International Organization:-

Definitions:-

International organization(s) is an entity established by a formal agreement or treaty between two or more nations to work together on shared issues.

Int. organizations are of two types

1) Inter-governmental Organizations (IGOs)

These are formed by governments.

Only sovereign states are its members.

Example: UN, WHO, WTO.

2. International Non-Governmental Organization (INGOs)

These are formed by private individuals or groups, not governments.

They operate across borders to promote social and pol. goals.

Example: Red Cross, Amnesty International.

Some other definitions:-

Int. organization is a body consists of group of actors for a common goal.

→ Int. organization is an institution with formal procedures and membership comprising three or more countries.

It helps manage relations b/w states in an increasingly interconnected world.

• I.O is a body established by agreements b/w states, possessing a permanent structure, defined objectives, and procedures for cooperation and decision-making in int. relations.

Evolution of Int. Organization:

Today's sophistication level in the structures of international organizations and proper cooperation & discussions are formed or emerged accidentally, but there were a lot of effort centuries' s efforts that produced such kind of int sophisticated international organizations.

Moreover, many events, ideas, and factors contributed in the development of international organization.

* The Chronological Development of I.O.

Intro: The evolution of Int. organization reflects humanity's shift from local survival to a deeply interconnected global system. It is a journey from temporary alliances to permanent, rule-based institutions.

The evolution of IOs is coincided with the development of ideas through the experience gained from various upheavals.

The chronological development of IOs is mentioned below:

- Treaty of Westphalia (1648)

The Peace of Westphalia (1648) was a big bang for the modern state system. It established the concept of state sovereignty which made state as a primary actor.

Industrial Revolution (19th cen)

With the beginning of industrial revolution, there was a significant growth in trade, transportation and communication which increased inter-state contacts, leading for mutual cooperation to facilitate trade and other activities etc.

And, as a result, it led to the establishment of some int. organizations:

- International Telegraph Organization (1865)
- Universal Postal Union (1874)
- Rhine River Commission

Moreover, some mechanisms and temporary rules and regulations existed before 20th century, but any permanent organization did not exist before 20th cent.

Date: _____

Day: _____

Rise of Napoleon:

The rise of Napoleon Bonaparte and the subsequent Napoleonic wars (1803-1815) catalyzed the evolution of I.O.s. This danger made European powers to realize the need for a more structured, multilateral approach to peace and security.

Congress of Vienna (1814-15)

This was a formal meeting of Europeans for peace, and to set the rules to restore stability and prevent imbalance in Europe.

The Concert of Europe:

Consequently, the congress of Vienna led to the establishment of "the Concert of Europe." This was a bold experiment in int. cooperation where major powers (Russia, Prussia, Austria, G. Britain & France) agreed to meet periodically to manage disputes, and ensure stability.

Shock of WWI:-

Despite many quasi IOs, the WWI erupted in 1914 which shattered the "balance of power" theory. Moreover, the world realized that ad-hoc conferences were not enough for sustained peace.

TREATY OF VERSAILLES:-

The Treaty of Versailles officially ended World War I b/w the Allied Powers and Germany. It was a large level int. agreement where many rules were established to avoid war. Similarly, the concept of 'Collective Security' was discussed.

→ LEAGUE OF NATIONS:-

The L.O.N. was the first worldwide intergovernmental organization to maintain global peace, prevent conflict through diplomacy and promote int. cooperation.

→ Economic Crisis in 1929:-

The economic crisis of 1929 further increased the need for an international level cooperation and regulation of market for mutual benefits.

Economic vulnerability due to free trade forced countries to take serious steps for int. orgo.

→ WWII: Shortcomings of L.O.N.

The L.O.N. could not succeed in its mission due to various reasons, and it resulted in the shape of World War II.

The WWII was so devastating that there were 67 million casualties — almost greatest in the history of world — which countries realized that security is the mutual concern, and war is mutually vulnerable for all together.

In the wake of this consciousness, the rebuilding of a failed organization became an inevitable necessity.

Thus, it resulted in the form of "United Nations",

aiming to maintain international peace, uphold human rights, prevent nuclear proliferation, and foster cooperation among nations.

Moreover, the WWII increased the need to collectively tackle many problems of mutual concern such as: nuclear proliferation, climate destruction, economic issues etc.

Consequently, these necessities paved the way for other branches/agencies of UN like IMF, WHO, UNICEF etc.

Theories of International Organization:

→ Realism ←

Realism is a major theory in International Relation (IR).

It, primarily, focusses on the world 'as it is'.

Its major concern is power politics. There are key views of Realists;

1. Anarchic Int-System:

Realists famously argues that international system is inherently anarchic. There is no centralized authority that can regulate state behavior.

2. State as Primary actor:

In this anarchic int. system, state is the sole primary actor. There is nothing, for a state, beyond its national interests. One of national interest

→ View about Int. org.

Realists are of the view that Int. organizations are an instrument of powerful states to serve and advance their own interests.

Similarly, powerful nations do not comply with the rules of IOs when their national interests are in jeopardy.

→ Relative Gains:-

States want to advance their interests by fulfilling relative gains, not absolute gains.

Relative gains: to gain power and wealth compared to others, rather than the absolute value of its own gains.

→ Balance of Power:-

According to realists, peace and stability can be maintained by balance of power. Each state should increase its power which would create deterrence for war.

★ Liberalism ★

Introduction:

Liberalism is one of the most influential schools of thought in int. relations. While realism focusses on the inevitable struggle for power, liberalism is fundamentally optimistic; it believes in the cooperation's possibility.

→ Main Points of Liberalism:

Although, Liberalism accepts the realism' view about human nature — selfishness, competition etc — but they argue that the world is a "positive-sum game"

where everyone can win through cooperation. It rejects the idea that int. politics is just a series of wars. Liberalism rests on three basic principles:

: Democracy

According to liberals, democratic form of government is the best one for cooperation among states. The "Democratic Peace Theory" suggests that democracies rarely go to war with one another.

: Free Trade:-

Moreover, liberals favor the complex economic interdependence. Global trade makes war too expensive b/c it would be harmful for all equally.

: Int. Institutions:-

Liberalism holds that international institutions are inevitable and foremost important platforms that help states communicate and resolve conflicts. These are essential tools for maintaining global order.

FEDERALISM :-

Intro:- Federalism is a system of political organization which prevents the centralization of power in a single authority. Instead, it is divided and shared between an ~~not~~ international & national units.

Key Principles:-

Unlike realism, which describes how the world is, Federalism focuses on how the world should be organized to prevent war.

View About State:-

This theory argues that the sovereign nation-state is the primary cause of conflict.

B/c states are not responsible to any higher authority (anarchy), they collide. Now the solution is that:

states must voluntarily surrender some of their sovereignty to a higher federal authority.

→ called "Charter of ..."

How Federalism would be:-

→ Constitutionalism:-

Federalism requires a formal written constitution that clearly defines which powers belong to national governments, and which belong to Federal Center.

→ All the matters that are commonly concerned to all (trade rules, courts, defense, etc) would be managed by central authorities.

→ On the other hand, for internal matters, state is free to make its policies as it likes.

→ Both, Federal and national, levels would work hand in hand.

→ However, national governments are not totally deprived of sovereignty, but they still possess sovereignty in a number of areas.

→ All the rules would be common and applied equally for all.

Example: European Union.

→ FUNCTIONALISM:

In the world of IR,
Functionalism is the "bottom-up"
approach to peace.

Functionalism does not focus
on power but on the
pipes, wires and trade routes
that connect us. The theory
suggests that global cooperation
should not start with big
political treaties, but with
practical "non-political" problems.

→ Imp. Views of Funct.....

If states have a common problem
(like managing a pandemic or coordinating
mail delivery), they will create a
specific organization to solve it.

→ The "Peace by Peaces" strategy

They believe that if you weave
states together in technical
areas (health, transport, science), they
will eventually become too inter-dependent
to go to war.

Technical vs. Political:-

The Theory distinguishes between "high politics" (sovereignty, borders, military) and "low politics" (economic and social welfare).

They believe that cooperation should start with low politics which would eventually influence the high."

The Spillover Effect:-

Success in one functional area spills over into another (eg shared currency), gradually eroding the importance of national borders.

: View of Int. Organizations:-

Int. organizations are created to fulfill specific needs that individual state cannot handle alone.

Agencies like the 'World Health Organization' and International 'Civil Aviation Organization (ICAO)' are the classic examples.